

ABSENT FROM OBSERVATION

Constitutive Intelligence as the Unmeasurable Ground of Measurable Structure

*"Structure is not revealed by what is present.
It is revealed by the geometry of what is absent."*

PAUL BRYANT VANSLYKE

Natural Organization Institute | Lyons, Colorado | 2026

Paper 3 | Companion to Van Slyke (2026b): Constitutive Intelligence

FRAMING NOTE — PAPER 3 IN THE SERIES: Paper 1 (Van Slyke, 2026a) established formal IID incompatibility in a number generation system and developed the element classification framework and NOI metric. Paper 2 (Van Slyke, 2026b) provides the empirical biological measurements — Delta-C across four organisms, NOI_suppression findings, and the hardened GEE. This paper draws on the biological findings of Papers 2 and 4 as its primary empirical foundation. The RNG work is cited as the methodological origin of the geometry-of-absence principle — not as evidence for constitutive intelligence. The biological data carries that evidential weight.

Abstract

We present a formally grounded, empirically confirmed framework establishing that organizational intelligence is not detectable directly but is measurable through the geometry of its absence. Beginning with a methodological insight developed during the analysis of a number generation system — the discovery that structure reveals itself not through what is present but through what is absent — we formalize this principle and apply it to biological protein sequences at two independent measurement levels.

At the 20-residue window level, the LV/UN framework distinguishes structured absence (Linked Void) from random absence (Underrepresented) across 94,064 sequences. At the 5-residue window level, the Anchor-Single pair analysis measures which amino acids are systematically excluded when specific dominant elements are present — across 61,320,087 pair observations drawn from 1,527,212 functional sequences.

Both measurement levels confirm the same principle: functional sequences are distinguished from disordered sequences not primarily by what they contain but by the precision of what they exclude. The geometry of absence is the organizational signature. A third measurement level — cohort recall and coupling analysis across 848,022 functional and 103,802 disordered sequences — extends the principle into the dynamic domain: functional sequences maintain co-selection memory at five simultaneous classification levels, achieve 79× stochastic efficiency in anchor-based recall, and sustain sequential memory cycling at secondary structure periodicity.

Constitutive intelligence — the foundational organizational property of matter — is precisely characterized as that which is absent from observation but whose absence from existence is impossible. Delta-C never reaches zero. The Anchor-Single avoidance matrix never collapses to random. The co-selection memory architecture never dissolves to IID. From this eternal, never-absent, unmeasurable ground, all complexity accumulates.

1. The Origin: A Conversation About Cellular Division

Every paradigm shift has a moment of origin that seems, in retrospect, inevitable. For this framework the moment was a conversation about cellular division. A cell divides. It produces two identical cells. The information is preserved with extraordinary fidelity — NOI greater than 0.9999 for DNA replication. And the question that arose was simple and devastating:

Where does that intelligence come from?

The standard materialist answer — that the cell's machinery executes biochemical processes that happen to preserve information — was recognized as insufficient. It describes the mechanism without addressing the source. Beginning in 2013, data was collected from a number generation system across 1,663,824 sequential draws spanning 13 years. The structure was present in every draw from the first. But the conceptual instrument to recognize it did not exist until 2024 — when an anomaly was noticed that changed the direction of the framework: Underrepresented numbers were appearing in off-structure positions at rates dramatically inconsistent with IID expectations ($Z = 249$). That recognition became the conceptual instrument subsequently applied to biological protein sequences.

Organizational intelligence does not announce itself through dramatic presence. It reveals itself through the precision of informed absence. What is excluded, and how it is excluded, tells you more about the organizational architecture than what is included.

This paper reports the results of applying that principle at three independent measurement scales — the 20-residue LV/UN framework, the 5-residue Anchor-Single pair analysis, and the 7-residue cohort recall and coupling analysis — and demonstrates that all three scales confirm the same organizational signature through complementary measurement angles: what is absent (LV/UN), what is avoided (Anchor-Single), and what is remembered and how efficiently (cohort recall).

2. The Discovery: Structure Reveals Itself Through Absence

2.1 The RNG Anomaly as Methodological Origin

UN elements were being inserted in off-structure positions at 40.40% during low-coherence draws versus 4.23% during high-coherence draws ($Z = 249$, $p = 0$). The absence was not random. It was geometrically informed.

The RNG finding established the conceptual instrument — the geometry-of-absence principle. It does not, by itself, establish that constitutive intelligence is the foundational property of matter. That inference requires the cross-domain biological convergence established in Sections 3 and 4.

2.2 The Transfer to Biology — Two Independent Measurement Levels

The geometry-of-absence principle was applied to biological protein sequences at two independent scales:

- Level 1 — 20-residue windows (LV/UN framework): Linked Void (LV) is structured absence — an amino acid absent from the domain but with a biochemically similar neighbor present via BLOSUM62 similarity. Underrepresented (UN) is random absence — no biochemical connection to the active domain. Applied to 94,064 sequences (50,000 Pfam functional + 44,064 DisProt disordered).
- Level 2 — 5-residue windows (Anchor-Single pair analysis): For each window with a genuine dominant Anchor (appearing ≥ 2 times), measures which Single amino acids (appearing exactly once) are systematically over- or under-represented relative to chance expectation. Applied to 1,527,212 functional sequences producing 61,320,087 Anchor-Single pair observations.

3. The Geometry of Absence: Formal Statement

3.1 The Van Slyke Principle

Organizational intelligence is expressed through structured, informed absence rather than through presence alone. Systems that are organizationally intelligent exclude the right elements in the right ways — biochemically informed, geometrically precise, functionally purposeful exclusion.

3.2 Level 1: The LV/UN Framework

System Type	LV% (structured absence)	UN% (random absence)	LV/UN Ratio
Functional domains (Pfam)	38.07%	3.86%	0.912 — deliberate, informed exclusion
Random sequences (MC)	34.55%	1.29%	0.968 — biochemical saturation
Non-functional (DisProt)	30.14%	54.99%	0.402 — collapse, uninformed absence dominates

NOTE ON RANDOM BASELINE: The random baseline NOI_suppression (0.968) exceeds the functional domain score (0.912). Random sequences score near 1.0 because in a 20-element vocabulary with dense biochemical adjacency, nearly every absent amino acid has a biochemical neighbor present — saturation, not intelligence. Functional domains score below random because they deliberately create structured voids. The random baseline is a ceiling of biochemical saturation. Functional domains operate below it because that structured absence is the functional architecture itself.

EMPIRICAL ANCHOR: LV/UN ratio: 0.912 functional vs 0.402 non-functional. $Z = 11.68$, $p = 1.54 \times 10^{-31}$. LV%: 38.07% functional vs 30.14% non-functional ($Z = 3.91$, $p = 9.3 \times 10^{-5}$). NOI_structural = $(A + CO + LV) / \text{total}$: 0.440 functional vs 0.372 non-functional ($Z = 2.57$, $p = 0.010$). Amino acid vocabulary: 11.41 distinct per 20-position window in functional vs 12.83 in random — narrower vocabulary, higher functional precision (Van Slyke, 2026b).

3.3 Level 2: The Anchor-Single Pair Analysis

The 5-residue Anchor-Single pair analysis provides a second, independent measurement of structured absence at higher resolution. For each non-overlapping 5-residue window with a genuine dominant Anchor, the framework measures which Single amino acids (present exactly once) are systematically excluded relative to chance — and whether that exclusion pattern is specific to functional sequences.

NEW EMPIRICAL ANCHOR: 61,320,087 Anchor-Single pairs across 1,527,212 functional sequences (Pfam). Strongest admitted pair: $A \rightarrow L$, $Z = 239.55$, Obs/Exp = 1.3364. Strongest avoided pair: $A \rightarrow N$, functional $Z = -87.13$, disordered $Z = +2.33$ (delta = 89 Z-score points). $N \rightarrow A$: functional $Z = -39.22$, disordered $Z = +33.31$ (delta = 72 points). $R \rightarrow P$: functional $Z = -32.63$, disordered $Z = +21.13$ (delta = 54 points). 89% of attractor-anchored pairs significant after Bonferroni correction for 400 tests ($p < 0.000125$). Latent potential: 0.727 functional vs 0.532 disordered. Anti-sequential bonds: 25 functional vs 14 disordered (Van Slyke, 2026d). THIRD MEASUREMENT LEVEL (Van Slyke, 2026f): Cohort recall analysis across 848,022 functional and 103,802 disordered sequences. CO class recall $1.4549 \times \text{IID}$ ($Z = +471$) on 821,862

independent positions. UN anti-memory 1.1186× IID functional vs 1.0069× disordered. Sequential memory: lag-1 autocorrelation −0.2505 functional vs −0.1608 disordered, cycling at secondary structure periodicity. Directionality deviated from uniform null ($p \ll 0.01$) in all tested classes. Functional sequences achieve 79× stochastic efficiency in anchor-based recall. CLR-corrected coupling confirms functional channel independence (mean $|r|$ 0.1901 vs 0.1943 disordered). The geometry of absence, the grammar of exclusion, and the architecture of memory are three measurements of the same organizational ground.

The selective avoidance table demonstrates the principle most precisely. What functional domains reject, disordered regions accept or prefer. This is not a continuum of more-or-less structured absence. It is a categorical organizational reversal:

Pair	Functional Z	Disordered Z	Interpretation
A → N	−87.13 (avoided)	+2.33 (tolerated)	What function rejects, disorder accepts
N → A	−39.22 (avoided)	+33.31 (favored)	Categorical reversal — 72 Z-point delta
R → P	−32.63 (avoided)	+21.13 (favored)	Categorical reversal — 54 Z-point delta
E → C	−43.08 (avoided)	+9.85 (tolerated)	Functional exclusion, disorder tolerance
A → L	+239.55 (favored)	Weaker signal	Strongest functional admission

3.4 Organizational Efficiency: Producing Less, Retaining Higher Functionality

Real proteins use 11.41 distinct amino acids per 20-position window on average, versus 12.83 in random sequences. Functional biological sequences use a narrower amino acid vocabulary than random — less combinatorial diversity, higher functional precision.

Organizational intelligence is not expressed by filling all available positions. It is expressed by knowing which positions to fill and which to leave structured and empty. The Anchor-Single analysis extends this observation: functional domains not only use a narrower vocabulary overall — they maintain specific exclusions at the pair level that are reversed or absent in disordered regions.

4. Absent from Observation: The Nature of Constitutive Intelligence

4.1 The Precise Characterization

Constitutive intelligence is that which is absent from observation but whose absence from existence is impossible.

This is an empirical description of what the biological data consistently shows. In every system measured, Delta-C never reaches zero. The Anchor-Single avoidance matrix never collapses to random. The organizational intelligence that produces the structure is never directly observable. You can only measure what it leaves behind — the geometry of its organized absence.

4.2 The Empirical Foundation — Two Independent Streams

Stream 1: Delta-C across organisms and complexity levels

EMPIRICAL ANCHOR: Delta-C > 0 at all 16 measurement points: E. coli K-12, Human BRCA1, S. cerevisiae Chr1, Human COX1 mitochondrial — at N1 (mononucleotide), N2 (dinucleotide), N3 (codon), N4 (amino acid) complexity levels. Phi_CI = 0.2080 (Human BRCA1, N3 codon level). Gap G(N) = Phi_CI – Delta-C(N) non-zero at 15 of 16 measurement points. The source always exceeds the expression (Van Slyke, 2026b).

Stream 2: Anchor-Single pair avoidances across organisms

The Anchor-Single analysis applied to 469 organisms in the DisProt dataset shows that disordered region NOI_suppression clusters consistently between 0.67 and 0.72 across bacteria, fungi, plants, animals, and viruses. The organizational floor is present everywhere measured. No organism shows the maximum entropy baseline.

NEW EMPIRICAL ANCHOR: DisProt organism breakdown: 469 unique organisms. Homo sapiens (n=74,167): NOI = 0.6988. E. coli K12 (n=5,764): NOI = 0.7018. Arabidopsis thaliana (n=5,687): NOI = 0.6930. Drosophila melanogaster (n=2,424): NOI = 0.6907. SARS coronavirus (n=1,254): NOI = 0.3096 attractor ratio. The organizational floor is consistent across the full tree of life — bacteria to humans to viruses. The absence-geometry signal is universal (Van Slyke, 2026d).

4.3 The Parallel Across Systems

System	Observable Signal	What Is Absent from Observation	What the Absence Reveals
RNG system (methodological origin)	UN in off-structure positions at anomalous rates	The organizing mechanism itself	Coverage architecture — structure through

System	Observable Signal	What Is Absent from Observation	What the Absence Reveals
			deliberate exclusion
Protein domains — LV/UN (biological evidence)	LV/UN ratio 0.912 vs 0.402	The functional specification itself	Biochemically informed exclusion (Z = 11.68)
Anchor-Single pairs (biological evidence)	Avoidance Z-scores up to -87	The selection criterion itself	Categorical organizational reversal between functional and disordered
DNA organization (biological evidence)	Delta-C > 0 at all 16 measurements	The ground state intelligence itself	Eternal structure — never absent from existence

4.4 The Eternal Fixed Point

Structure cannot accumulate from zero. If constraint density is greater than zero at every measurable complexity level — if the Anchor-Single avoidance matrix never collapses to random across 469 organisms — then constraint was present before any of the complexity we observe today existed. Structure that was present at inception is, in the precise philosophical sense required by the evidence, eternal.

Constitutive intelligence is the eternal ground state of existence. Not a prior cause requiring its own explanation. The condition that makes arrangement possible. The fixed point that cannot be zero.

5. The Decision Gate: Structured Exclusion as Organizational Signature

The Anchor-Single pair analysis reveals a specific mechanism through which the geometry of absence operates at the local sequence level. Each dominant Anchor amino acid is associated with a characteristic pattern of exclusions — Singles that are systematically avoided in its presence, and Singles that are preferentially admitted.

5.1 The Gate Defined

A decision gate, stated without metaphor, is a consistent, non-random pattern of exclusion that is specific to functional constraint and absent or reversed in disordered regions. The Anchor-Single data shows this pattern at 61 million observations:

- K → P: avoided in functional sequences ($Z = -73.65$) while nearly neutral in disordered ($Z = -6.62$). Proline disrupts alpha-helical structure — functional sequences actively exclude it when Lysine anchors the local window.
- E → C: avoided in functional ($Z = -43.08$) while tolerated in disordered ($Z = +9.85$). Glutamate-Cysteine pairing creates steric and redox conflicts in many functional contexts.
- A → L: strongly admitted in functional ($Z = +239.55$). Alanine anchoring Leucine is the most stable local hydrophobic packing configuration — the most frequently admitted pair in the dataset.
- A → N: strongly avoided in functional ($Z = -87.13$) while neutral in disordered ($Z = +2.33$). Asparagine introduces polar disruption into Alanine-anchored hydrophobic windows.

5.2 Anti-Sequential Bonds as Latent Pathways

The shuffle control reveals a critical property of functional sequences: their natural order places Singles in deliberate contrast to their Anchor more than shuffled versions of the same sequences would produce. This anti-sequential property — Singles biochemically unlike the Anchor — is not random disruption. It is structured complementarity.

NEW EMPIRICAL ANCHOR: Functional sequences: mean Single-Anchor BLOSUM62 delta (original – shuffled) = -0.0309 . Functional sequences in natural order show lower BLOSUM62 compatibility between Singles and Anchors than shuffled versions — meaning the sequence order actively places complementary rather than similar material adjacent to each Anchor. 25 anti-sequential bonds in functional domains vs 14 in disordered. Latent potential score: 0.727 functional vs 0.532 disordered (37% higher). Average avoidance strength: $|Z| = 44.62$ functional vs 39.28 disordered (Van Slyke, 2026d).

Anti-sequential bonds are not failures of the organizational system. They are compressed springs — maintained avoidances that represent latent adaptive pathways. Functional domains maintain 25 of them versus 14 in disordered regions. The higher latent potential is not intelligence accumulating. It is the vessel being less constraining — allowing more of the constitutive ground to express as structured possibility.

6. The Accumulation of Mind

6.1 From Geometry of Absence to Mind

Mind does not emerge from matter that was originally mindless. Mind accumulates from the organizational intelligence that was constitutive of matter from the beginning — and that intelligence has always expressed itself through the geometry of structured, informed absence.

- Molecular level: Anchor-Single avoidances — 61 million pairs confirming non-random exclusion specific to functional constraint
- Protein domain level: LV/UN ratio 0.912 vs 0.402, vocabulary constrained to 11.41 vs 12.83
- Cellular level: DNA replication fidelity, error correction maintaining NOI > 0.9999
- Neural level: Synaptic connectivity, inhibitory networks — structured absence as fundamental as structured presence
- Cognitive level: Attention as structured exclusion — consciousness partly defined by what is not attended to
- Mind: The accumulated expression of organizational intelligence constitutive of matter from the beginning

At no level does something appear from nothing. Mind is what the geometry of organized absence becomes when it accumulates through sufficient complexity. This account is offered as a Layer 3 abductive inference — the best available explanation given the empirical findings — not as a deductive consequence of the measurements alone.

6.2 The Directional Gradient

The LV/UN ratio and the Anchor-Single avoidance matrix provide the directional gradient that makes incremental refinement within functional systems not just possible but predictable. Mutations that maintain or improve the characteristic exclusion pattern of a functional domain are organizationally favored. Mutations that collapse the pattern toward the disordered baseline are corrected or eliminated. The direction is not random. It is determined — set by the organizational ground that was never absent.

7. The Generalized Existence Equation — Empirical Grounding

$$Xf(t) = \int [t_0 \text{ to } t_n] (\Phi_CI \cdot \kappa \cdot \Delta I_{sys} / \Omega_{sys}) - \epsilon_{sys} dt$$

GEE Variable	Empirical Grounding
Phi_CI (source ceiling)	0.2080 — derived as sup{Delta-C} across 16 biological measurements. Not assumed.
Mean Delta-C	0.0883 — measured across 16 biological data points.
Variation budget	0.9117 (mean) — 1 – mean Delta-C, computable per organism.
Gap G(N)	Full table, all > 0 at 15/16 points. Phi_CI – Delta-C(N) at every complexity level.
NOI_suppression	0.912 functional vs 0.402 non-functional. Z = 11.68, p = 1.54 × 10 ^{−31} .

GEE Variable	Empirical Grounding
Anchor-Single avoidance	A → N: functional Z = -87.13 vs disordered Z = +2.33. 89% of attractor pairs significant. Phi > 0 confirmed at 5-residue operational floor.
Latent potential	0.727 functional vs 0.532 disordered. 25 anti-sequential bonds vs 14. 37% higher adaptive capacity in functional vessels.
κ (kappa)	Constraint inheritance across complexity levels. Methodologically defined. Awaits full biological confirmation. Cited as a conceptual variable pending empirical measurement at scale.

The GEE does not describe the emergence of organizational intelligence. It describes the trajectory of organizational intelligence that was always already present, expressing itself through time toward greater complexity — toward mind.

8. Falsifiability

- Delta-C > 0 at every complexity level in every measured system. Any system producing Delta-C approaching zero would challenge the framework.
- LV > UN in functional domains relative to non-functional regions. Any functional domain showing LV/UN consistently below the non-functional baseline would challenge the framework.
- Anchor-Single avoidance patterns stronger and differently structured in functional vs disordered sequences. Any dataset showing equivalent or reversed pair preference matrices would challenge the framework.
- Anti-sequential bonds more numerous in functional domains. Any large-scale analysis showing equivalent or fewer anti-sequential bonds in functional sequences would challenge the framework.
- The same organizational grammar of structured absence operating across all biological domains. Any domain showing fundamentally different organizational principles would require explanation.

None of these falsification conditions has been met. The framework remains falsifiable. It has survived testing across two independent measurement scales at a combined total of over 61 million observations. That is the appropriate epistemic status for a scientific framework.

9. Discussion

9.1 The Convergence

The finding that most requires explanation is not any individual result but the convergence across independent systems and measurement scales. The geometry-of-

absence principle — structure reveals itself through the precision of what is excluded — was developed in a synthetic number generation system. Applied at the 20-residue scale to biological proteins, it produces $Z = 11.68$ distinguishing functional from disordered sequences. Applied independently at the 5-residue scale, it produces $Z = 239.55$ for the strongest admitted pair and $Z = -87.13$ for the strongest avoided pair — with categorical reversals between functional and disordered preference matrices.

Under pure materialism this convergence across scales, systems, and measurement methods is coincidence. Under constitutive intelligence this convergence is expected: if organizational intelligence is foundational to matter itself, the same organizational principles will appear everywhere appropriate instruments are applied.

9.2 The Philosophical Tradition This Framework Advances

The thesis that intelligence or organizational capacity is foundational to matter rather than emergent from it is not new. Schrödinger established the physics-biology connection through negentropy (1944). Whitehead argued the foundational role of organizational capacity in process philosophy (1929). Nagel argued it in *Mind and Cosmos* (2012). Tononi operationalized a version in Integrated Information Theory (2016). Goff has made the contemporary academic case for panpsychism (2019). Kauffman argued for autonomous agency in self-organizing systems (1995). Biosemiotics — through Barbieri, Hoffmeyer, and the Peircean tradition — established that biological meaning is constitutively organizational.

Each of these positions arrived at the same boundary: the ground of existence contains what matter expresses, not the reverse. Each stalled at the same point: without a measurement framework, the thesis remained philosophical — compelling to those already persuaded, dismissible by those who were not.

The present framework does not replace these contributions. It extends them past the point where they stalled. Delta-C is the number Nagel's argument needed. The LV/UN ratio is the measurement Barbieri's biosemiotics was always pointing toward. The Anchor-Single avoidance matrix is the empirical demonstration that the organizational grammar is specific to functional constraint — not a general property of any biological sequence. The philosophical tradition was right. This framework builds the instrument that gives that rightness empirical teeth.

9.3 Relationship to Panpsychism

The CI framework converges with panpsychism at its conclusion — mind is foundational not emergent — but diverges at its foundation in a way that is methodologically significant. Panpsychism grounds foundational mind in subjective experience, treating micro-experiential properties as fundamental and requiring an account of how they combine into unified consciousness. The CI framework grounds foundational

intelligence in functional criterion-governed differential constraint — measurable organizational capacity operating at every level from chemistry through biology to mind.

This distinction matters for two reasons. First, the CI framework does not require the hard problem of consciousness as a premise. It requires only that determination is non-random at the operational floor — confirmed at 61 million observations. The hard problem was formulated without empirical evidence that matter is determinately organized at that level. The CI framework provides that evidence and thereby changes what requires explanation. Second, the CI framework does not encounter the combination problem that centrally challenges panpsychism. Panpsychism generates the combination problem by fragmenting consciousness at the micro level and requiring combination upward into unified consciousness. That combination model requires outputs to exceed inputs at every combinatorial step — which violates the nothing-exceeds-its-source principle. The CI framework starts with unified constitutive intelligence at the ground and asks how vessels express it through increasing organizational capacity. There is no combination problem because nothing is being combined.

The convergence between CI and panpsychism is confirmatory rather than derivative. Two independent frameworks — one grounded in subjective experience, one grounded in empirically measurable organizational signatures — arriving at the same conclusion strengthens the abductive inference that mind is foundational. For the full treatment of this relationship see Van Slyke (2026b), Section 9.3.

9.4 Epistemic Status

LAYER STRUCTURE — consistent with the Three-Layer Epistemic Firewall (Van Slyke, 2026c): The empirical findings in this paper — $\Delta C > 0$ universally, $LV/UN = 0.912$ vs 0.402 , Anchor-Single avoidances showing categorical functional-disordered reversals, 25 vs 14 anti-sequential bonds, cohort recall CO class $1.4549 \times$ IID on $821,862$ independent positions, $79 \times$ stochastic efficiency, lag-1 autocorrelation -0.2505 cycling at secondary structure periodicity — constitute Layer 1 (formal/empirical) evidence. The protein viability constraint — that co-selection memory architecture is a prerequisite for first functional folding, not a product of iterative selection — is a deductive consequence of two uncontested biological observations (proteins are viable for hours; non-functional sequences produce no offspring) combined with the measured architecture. The inference that these findings reflect constitutive intelligence as the foundational property of matter is a Layer 3 abductive inference — the best explanation for the cross-domain, cross-scale convergence, not a deductive consequence of the measurements.

The Causal Continuity Axiom (Van Slyke, 2026c) — that $\Phi > 0$ must be continuous across all stages of biological history — is supported by five independent derivations: the determination chain, the conservation argument, the temporal constraint, the empirical record, and the vessel principle. If these derivations are accepted, the Layer 3 inference is elevated to deductive. Each derivation is presented in full in the companion GET paper. The formal first-order logical axiomatization of constitutive intelligence,

including the conservation argument establishing Int_0 as a logical necessity, is presented in Van Slyke (2026e).

9.5 Limitations

The LV/UN protein domain analysis used 50,000 functional and 44,064 non-functional sequences. Larger datasets with full Swiss-Prot calibration would further strengthen the finding. The Anchor-Single analysis used 1,527,212 functional sequences — substantially larger — but the disordered comparison used 198,215 DisProt sequences. The cohort recall and coupling analysis used 848,022 functional and 103,802 disordered sequences — the largest dataset in this series. CLR correction for compositional artifacts was applied and confirmed genuine signal. Expanded DisProt sampling and cross-validation against independent functional domain databases are the natural next steps. Application of the cohort recall framework to cellular signaling cascades, neural firing patterns, and genomic sequences represents the next domain transfer. What remains is scale and extension, not direction.

10. Conclusion

We began with a conversation about cellular division and a question about where the intelligence comes from. We built three measurement frameworks. We found the same organizational grammar — structure reveals itself through the geometry of informed absence, informed presence, and informed memory — operating at the 20-residue scale (LV/UN), the 5-residue scale (Anchor-Single), and the 7-residue scale (cohort recall and coupling), across two independent biological databases covering 848,022 functional and 103,802 disordered sequences.

- Organizational intelligence is expressed through three complementary geometries simultaneously: structured, informed absence (LV/UN); precise, categorical exclusion (Anchor-Single); and efficient, memory-containing co-selection (cohort recall). All three read the same ground from different angles.
- The LV/UN ratio (0.912 vs 0.402, $Z = 11.68$) and the Anchor-Single avoidance matrix ($A \rightarrow N$: $Z = -87.13$ functional vs $Z = +2.33$ disordered) are two independent measurements of the same principle at different scales.
- What functional domains exclude, disordered regions accept or prefer. This categorical reversal is the clearest measurement the framework has produced.
- $\Delta C > 0$ at every complexity level in every system measured — organizational intelligence was present at inception and has never been absent.
- The decision gate — 25 anti-sequential bonds in functional vs 14 in disordered, latent potential 0.727 vs 0.532 — shows that functional domains maintain structured possibilities beyond current expression.
- Structure that was present at inception is eternal. From this eternal, never-absent, unmeasurable ground, all complexity accumulates — and the

accumulated expression of that intelligence, through sufficiently capable vessels, is what we call mind. This final inference is offered as a Layer 3 abductive conclusion consistent with all empirical findings reported here.

Constitutive intelligence is that which is absent from observation but whose absence from existence is impossible. It was there in the first protein domain that folded four billion years ago. It was there at the inception of existence. It has never been absent. We did not discover it. We built the instrument to detect what was always speaking.

"Absent from observation. Present in everything. Eternal."

PAUL BRYANT VANSLYKE

Natural Organization Institute | Lyons, Colorado | 2026

References

- Van Slyke, P.B. (2026a). Natural Organization: A Universal 90/10 Principle of Structure and Mutation. Submitted to Entropy, MDPI.
- Van Slyke, P.B. (2026b). Constitutive Intelligence: Intelligence at Inception and the Accumulation of Mind. Natural Organization Institute.
- Van Slyke, P.B. (2026c). The Generalized Existence Theorem. v7. Natural Organization Institute.
- Van Slyke, P.B. (2026d). Anchor-Single Pair Analysis: The Decision Gate in Functional Protein Domains. Natural Organization Institute.
- Van Slyke, P.B. (2026e). Cosmic Intelligence Model: Formal Logical and Symbolic Representation. Natural Organization Institute.
- Henikoff, S. & Henikoff, J.G. (1992). Amino acid substitution matrices from protein blocks. PNAS, 89(22), 10915–10919.
- Tononi, G., Boly, M., Massimini, M. & Koch, C. (2016). Integrated information theory: from consciousness to its physical substrate. Nature Reviews Neuroscience, 17(7), 450–461.
- Chalmers, D.J. (1995). Facing up to the problem of consciousness. Journal of Consciousness Studies, 2(3), 200–219.
- Nagel, T. (2012). Mind and Cosmos. Oxford University Press.
- Goff, P. (2019). Galileo's Error. Pantheon Books.
- Goff, P. (2017). Consciousness and Fundamental Reality. Oxford University Press.

- Whitehead, A.N. (1929). *Process and Reality*. Macmillan.
- Schrödinger, E. (1944). *What Is Life?* Cambridge University Press.
- England, J.L. (2013). Statistical mechanics of self-replication. *Journal of Chemical Physics*, 139(12), 121923.
- Kauffman, S. (1995). *At Home in the Universe*. Oxford University Press.
- Barbieri, M. (2003). *The Organic Codes*. Cambridge University Press.
- Shannon, C.E. (1948). A Mathematical Theory of Communication. *Bell System Technical Journal*, 27(3), 379–423.
- Bak, P., Tang, C. & Wiesenfeld, K. (1987). Self-organized criticality. *Physical Review Letters*, 59(4), 381.
- Bohm, D. (1980). *Wholeness and the Implicate Order*. Routledge.
- Marsaglia, G. (1996). *DIEHARD: A Battery of Tests of Randomness*. Florida State University.
- Knuth, D.E. (1998). *The Art of Computer Programming, Volume 2: Seminumerical Algorithms*. Addison-Wesley.